

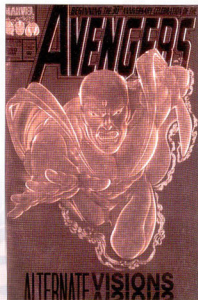
THE AVENGERS IN THE 1990s

THE NEW DECADE BEGAN with John Byrne still writing both *Avengers* titles. He was also drawing the West Coast book while penciler Paul Ryan and inker Tom Palmer handled the art for the East Coasters. Fabian Nicieza dropped in to write *The Crossing Line* in mid-1990, a thriller that involved a stolen nuclear submarine, Alpha Flight and a team of Russian super heroes. Larry Hama took over the scripting of the East Coast title and

introduced new villains like Ngh the Unspeakeable, and the Brethren and brought back old favorites like Doctor Doom and the Collector.

Roy Thomas returned to the *Avengers* in 1990 with a stint on the West Coast title that saw the team through *Operation: Galactic Storm* and clashes with Immortus, Ultron, and Goliath. Bob Harras and Steve Epting assumed creative control of the East Coast title in 1992 and brought back the Swordsman, made Hercules fall in love, forced the Black Knight to choose between Crystal and Sersi, and revealed the Gatherers' secret.

The title was discontinued in 1996 and Marvel hired Rob Liefeld and his studio to modernize the *Avengers*. It was later decided that Rob's stories occurred in a pocket universe and the *Avengers* were relaunched in 1998 under the creative guidance of Kurt Busiek, George Perez and Al Vey, who took a back-to-basics approach to the title.



The Avengers #360 (March 1993) The *Avengers* celebrate 30 years of continuous publication with a figure of the Vision embossed on a gold foil cover. (Cover by Steve Epting and Tom Palmer)



The Avengers #350 (Aug. 1992) The X-Men and Starjammers help the *Avengers* celebrate their 350th issue. (Cover by Steve Epting and Tom Palmer)

1990



The Avengers #314 (Feb. 1990) Spider-Man stops in for a visit as reality blinks out of existence. (Cover by Paul Ryan)

1992



The Avengers #348 (June 1992) The Vision and the Scarlet Witch say goodbye. (Cover by Steve Epting and Tom Palmer)

1993



Avengers: The Terminatrix Objective #1 (Sept. 1993) A four-issue series: Ravonna takes on Kang. (Cover by Mike Gustovich)

1994



The Avengers #374 (May 1994) Proctor reveals his love and hatred for Sersi. (Cover by Steve Epting and Tom Palmer)

1995



The Avengers #384 (March 1995) Hercules loses his mortal love. (Cover by Tom Palmer)

1996



Avengers Vol. 2 #1 (Nov. 1996) The *Avengers* get a makeover. (Cover by Rob Liefeld)

1998



Avengers Vol. 3 #4 (May 1998) A new team is chosen. (Cover by George Perez)

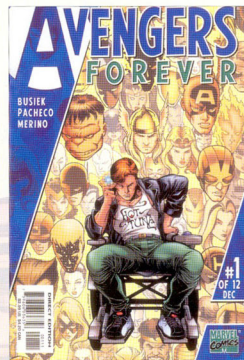
1999



Avengers Vol. 3 #21 (Oct. 1999) The *Avengers* battle Ultron. (Cover by George Perez)



The Avengers #402 (Sept. 1996) The *Avengers* celebrate the end of an era as the first volume of the title draws to a close after 33 years. (Cover by Tom Palmer)



Avengers Forever #1 (Dec. 1998) Rick Jones is a major player in a twelve issue war between Kang and Immortus that revisits key moments in *Avengers* history. (Cover by Carlos Pacheco and Jesus Merino)